



◀ THE LARGEST land mammal of all time, *Paraceratherium* weighed about 16½ tons (15 metric tons)—twice as much as *Tyrannosaurus* and four times heavier than an elephant.



Elasmotherium

ell-AZZ-moe-THEER-ee-um



- **When** 2 million–126,000 years ago or later
- **Fossil location** Asia
- **Habitat** Plains
- **Length** 20 ft (6 m)
- **Diet** Grass

Elasmotherium was a large rhinoceros, weighing about 3 tons, that lived until ice age times and may have been hunted by early people. Its huge, single horn has inspired theories that this animal was the source of the unicorn myth, although it probably vanished too early in history to be remembered even in folk tales. With legs longer than a modern rhino's, *Elasmotherium* may have been quicker on its feet. Its teeth were large and flat-topped—adapted to a diet of grass and small plants, which it perhaps tore from the ground by swinging its head.

Subhyracodon

sub-high-RACK-oh-don



- **When** 33–25 million years ago (Late Paleogene)
- **Fossil location** USA
- **Habitat** Plains
- **Length** 9 ft (3 m)
- **Diet** Plants

This cow-sized rhinoceros had no horns and was not heavily armored like modern rhinoceroses. Instead, *Subhyracodon* relied on its long, slender legs to flee from danger. Its teeth had sharp crests, well-suited to mashing leaves from trees and bushes.

